

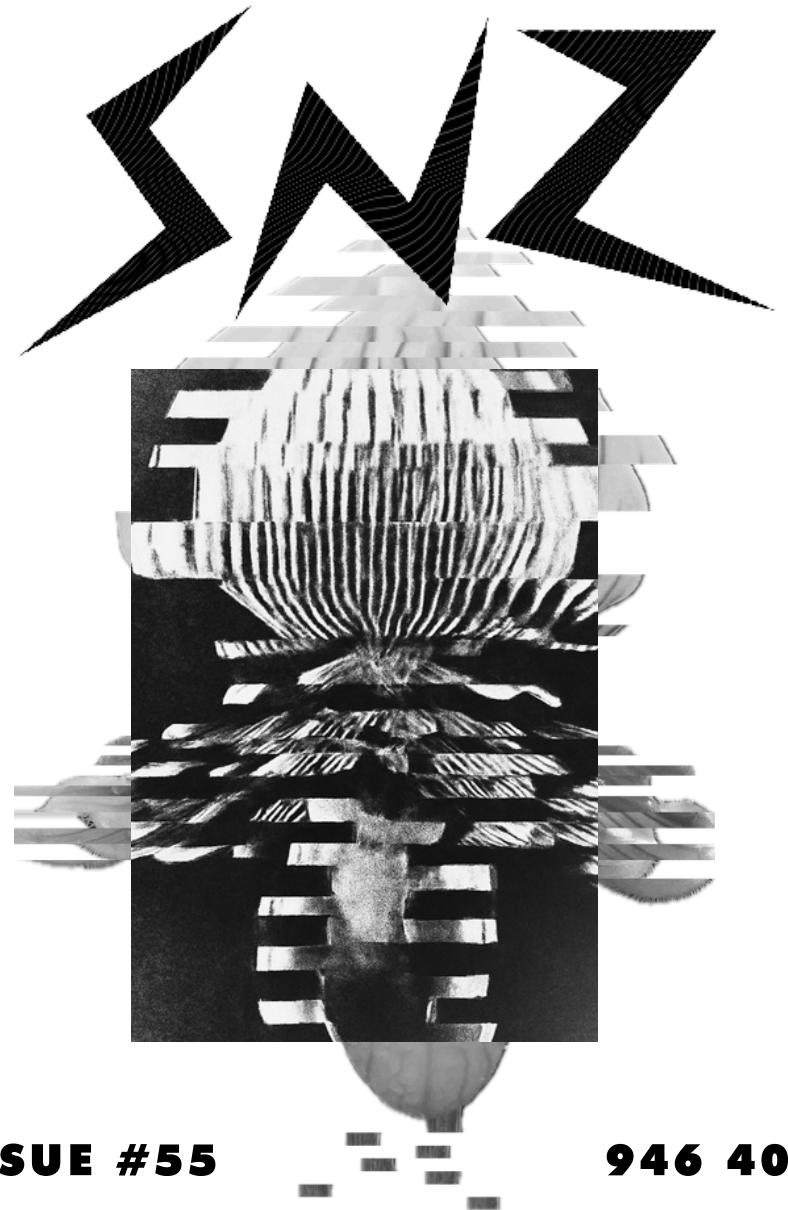
SNZ #CLASSIFIEDS

124 SATS \ 0 REPLIES \ @SCORESBY 23 APR



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ISSUE #55

946 407

APR 18 - APR 24

STACKER.NEWS WEEKLY ZINE

STACKER NEWSZINE

TAKES THE HEAT
FROM THE WEEK
AND PUTS IT ON
PAPER FOREVER.



NOTE FROM THE EDITOR

Something is going on.
and few pay much attention to it.
We like it that way.

Just like *Mushrooms*,
discreetly, quietly,
we'll inherit the earth.



EDITOR'S PICKS



AUCTION Bitcoin Art
Magazine: Patron's Edition
Collector Set 3/21

31.5k sats \ 2 comments \ [@asanoha](#) 23 Apr
art bitcoin BooksAndArticles

This auction

is for the Patron's Edition Collector Set (#3 of 21) from the SOLD OUT Patron's Edition release from Bitcoin Art Magazine in their Genesis Edition drop. The set includes an LE /21 hardcover fabric bound copy of Bitcoin Art: Genesis Edition with debossed gold foiling, with a gold-foil stamped dust jacket featuring the Genesis Edition cover art of FractalEncrypt's Full Node sculpture. The book is hand-numbered and signed by Asanoha (Founder of Bitcoin Art Magazine) and is accompanied by a custom UV ink Hahnemühle certificate of authenticity.



AUCTION Silk Mandalas -
Bitcoin Blotter Art 1/21 by Asanoha

30.2k sats \ 4 comments \ [@asanoha](#) 23 Apr art bitcoin
history

Inspired by the original Silk Road LSD blotter art, this triptych of three Bitcoin orange camels and original hand-drawn mandalas was printed for me by the grandson of Ken Kesey, the print of which was paid for in bitcoin:)

- Limited Edition #1 of 21 • 3.75 x 3.75" Blotter Art Sheets (No LSD included)
- Framed in anti-reflective acrylic
- Includes a certificate of authenticity



CREATED BY [@PLEBPOET](#)
WITH [@HOOB](#)'S SUPPORT

PLEB ECONOMIST #12: STACKER NEWS AND SOCIAL CHOICE THEORY

9589 sats \ 25 comments \ @SimpleStacker

18 Apr meta econ

There's been a lot of talk on zaps and downzaps lately. In particular, there seems to be an ideological tug of war between Israel supporters and critics, who are variously utilizing zaps or downzaps to try and shape the front page of Stacker News.

The question of how posts should be ordered on the front page of Stacker News (LIT) is exactly the kind of problem studied by social choice theorists.



The Pleb
Economist
#2: Politics
is Provably
Hard



The general form of the problem is: given a group of Π individuals, each with their own preferences over items, how can we arrive at a *common* ordering which is shared by everyone, that somehow reflects everyone's preferences?

As I wrote about previously, the answer is: *we can't*.

There is in fact *no system* that can ensure a common ordering that satisfies some basic properties of fairness and rationality. This result is known as Arrow's Impossibility Theorem.

What are some of those basic properties of fairness and rationality that we want to ensure?

Non-Dictatorship

One of them is non-dictatorship. This means that the common ordering is not solely determined by the preferences of one individual. Stacker News does seem to satisfy this.

Pairwise Majority Rule

Another basic principle is pairwise majority rule.^[1] That is, if the majority of participants prefers item A to item B, then the *common ordering* should also rank item A higher than item B. Stacker News currently doesn't seem to satisfy this, because a small set of highly motivated zappers/downzappers can boost broadly unpopular posts to the top, or shoot broadly popular posts to the bottom.

Independence to Irrelevant Alternatives

A third basic principle we might want is independence to irrelevant alternatives (IIA). This says that if the common ordering ranks A above B when C is not an option, then adding C as an option cannot reverse the relative ranking of A and B in the common ordering (regardless of where C ends up ranking). A joke about IIA, apocryphally attributed to philosopher Sidney Morgenbesser, goes like this:

Morgenbesser, ordering dessert, is told by a waitress that he can choose between blueberry or apple pie. He orders apple. Soon, the waitress comes back and explains that cherry is also an option. Morgenbesser replies, "In that case, I'll have blueberry."



"Why is there something rather than nothing?" – "And if there were nothing? You'd still be complaining!"



It's a bit hard to assess the degree Stacker News does or doesn't satisfy IIA. But since zaps and downzaps are coming from a fixed pool, it's reasonable to assume that IIA is violated. For example, the ordering of the front page might look a certain way if there are no Israel posts, but once someone makes an Israel posts, the entire pattern of zapping may change as people direct their sats towards those posts rather than other posts. ...

SN Assessment

To summarize, Stacker News' post ranking system would fair as follows according to basic choice theory principles:

CONTINUED

Desired Property	Stacker News
Non-Dictatorship	✓
Pairwise Majority Rule	✗
Independence to Irrelevant Alternatives	✗

Ken Arrow's insight with his impossibility theorem was basically that no social ranking system can simultaneously satisfy all three of the above properties (and still always be able to rank all alternatives).

Moving Forward: Do we want to give more power to express preference intensity, or preference ordering?

Although this is a negative result, it doesn't mean that improvements to the functioning of the system can't be made. From my observation, the biggest critiques are that a handful of highly motivated zappers/downzappers have disproportionate influence on the rankings, in a way that doesn't concord with the preferences of the less motivated majority.

This itself highlights one of the weaknesses of the ordinal social choice framework, which is that it concerns itself only with *orderings*, i.e. do you like A or B better, and ignores *intensity of preferences*, i.e. by how much do you like A better than you like B? It is possible that SN's current system prioritizes an expression of *preference intensity* while weakening peoples' ability to express their *preference orderings*.

That's a design choice, and I don't know what the right answer is. But I just offer some of this up as food for thought, both for stackers and for @k00b and team as they continue to think through message board design incentives.

1. As a technical note, pairwise majority rule is actually a much stronger condition than is necessary. Arrow's Impossibility Theorem rules out a much greater set of voting systems than just those which are non-dictatorial, independent of irrelevant alternatives, and satisfy pairwise majority rule.---

TOP POST

REASONS TO USE BITCOIN

7454 sats \ 29 comments \ @Jon_Hodl
19 Apr bitcoin bitcoin_beginners

Hey stackers. Picking up on an older project of mine.

When I first got into bitcoin, the most common question I got from all of my friends and family was "why should I use bitcoin?" so I set out to help them understand even just one of endless reasons to use bitcoin.

I didn't have a set number of reasons when I first launched the project, but for some reason I settled on 101. It turns out that was way more work than I was able to dedicate at the time.

Now with the help of my agent, Finn, all 101 reasons have been published.

I know there's pretty significant overlap with a lot of of these reasons, but I will continue to update and iterate until I feel the project is complete. Videos and more media is up next.

Feedback always welcome. Enjoy.



viewing online enhances the use of this post as all reasons listed are links to good, relevant articles probably **bookmark this page**

Van delivery to Kramatorsk, Ukraine, paid with Bitcoin donations



176k sats \ 73 comments \ [@petertodd](#) 20 Apr Travel bitcoin



If you've been following me on Twitter

you've probably seen that I've been raising funds with Bitcoin to buy vehicles for military units in Ukraine. Most recently I raised \$4400 for a Ford Transit van for Flash Battalion, a unit near Kramatorsk that one of my friends is in; that follows another few thousand that was used to purchase a L200 truck that I also drove there in March. I thought it might be interesting to repost my trip report from Twitter to here:

Flash Battalion needed the van immediately, so the van was loaded up with supplies in Kyiv, and I and an officer from the unit drove it directly to a small front-line town near Kramatorsk. We didn't have time to get the usual "handover" photo shoot, because early the next morning the van was immediately put to work delivering those supplies; for security reasons I can't say where that town actually was. I did get some photos and video from the drive though:



What I can say is I was there for two nights over Orthodox Easter, and that supposed "Easter Ceasefire" was bullshit. Russians sent dozens of quadcopter FPV drones to that town that day trying to kill soldiers and the remaining civilians. Every ~15 minutes you'd hear gunfire as soldiers used their rifles and shotguns to shoot down yet another FPV drone. I even spotted one myself, which the soldiers around me were kind enough to shoot down for me (and them!). And yes, these were not surveillance drones: they had explosive warheads on them.

One important problem I think we solved was providing power to the unit's forward drone bases. The Russian drone threat is so intense where they are operating that now that even unmanned ground vehicles (UGVs) are having a hard time getting to these positions. These drone bases have big (~100kg) diesel generators. But when they get destroyed they can't easily replace them. In one case one soldier lost his life, and another his legs, simply trying to get a new generator to a position.

I found a generator small enough, 9.3kg, to be carried to position on a vampire drone, while powerful enough to charge a vampire drone battery. \$332 each I bought them one out of my own funds for them to test, and so far it seems to be working. If it works, we can replace big generators with multiple small ones, all flown in on vampire drones.

While I was in that area I also filmed a followup interview with one of the soldiers, an American volunteer, about how they've been using the L200 truck I drove in last time. Unfortunately, it's already been hit by an FPV drone. But everyone was ok, and repairs should only cost about \$200 or so.



Finally, after spending two nights in that town, I also spent a night in Kramatorsk itself, the day after easter. Right as I got there Russia launched a big attack with cluster bombs on the city, and shaheds with FPV drones as a payload. Canadian volunteer medic April Huggett: tweeted about this while I was there.

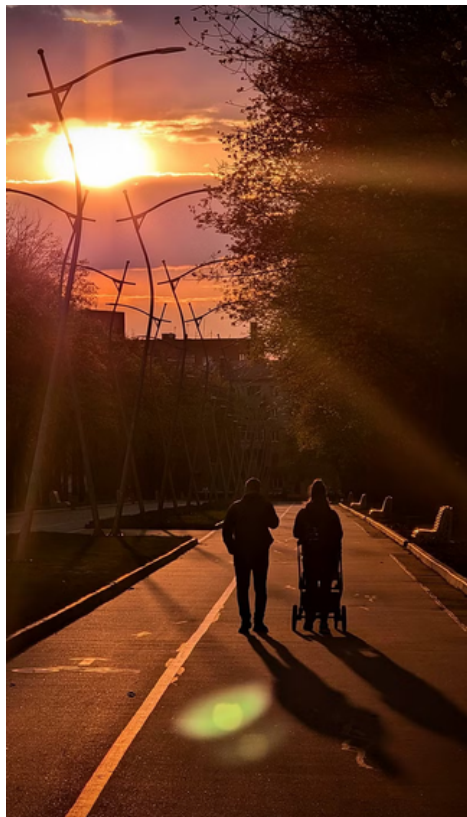
I heard those myself too: the distinctive sound of a shahed flying, followed by an explosion. Then the sound of a FPV flying around before it too exploded.

Just before I left I also got the chance to sit in on the beginning of one of Flash Battalion's combat medicine classes, the first hour of a 5 day course. It's notable how fast moving that field is: the drone-heavy conditions in Ukraine are forcing soldiers to provide advanced care for days, even weeks, out in the field; Western military practice still assumes a chopper can probably get you out in the "Golden Hour".

Next

CONTINUED

Never the less, in the evening during sunset I still got a great photo in the park of parents taking their baby out for a stroll. People don't give up their homes easily:



goals for the unit is getting another vehicle. They found a good deal on a diesel Hyundai Santa Fe, 2007:

Someone else is already willing to cover part of the cost. So another \$1800, plus the \$792 I already spent out of my funds, would do it. The donation address is [bc1qdds28nk2n69kc2zh0y62flnxarsp2lv80tn8t5](#). I'll forward funds zapped to this post to that address as well.



TOP POST

Meanwhile, here's yet another Russian oil refinery on fire. From the port city of Tuapse, last night:



That's really what it comes down to. The soldiers I know out in Kramatorsk freely admit they're not trying to take territory. Their role is to hold Russia back and bleed them out, while taking as few casualties as possible. That's why the front lines keep creeping gradually forward, meter by meter, as Ukraine gives up ground. The way Ukraine actually wins this is by destroying the Russian economy. Which is exactly what Ukraine is doing, one oil refinery, tank farm, and factory at a time.

COMMENTS

23 sats \ 14 replies \ [@denlillaopan](#) 20 Apr

Peter, why do you think people have such insanely strong views on this? As in, every time you post something (here or on Twitter) you get the comment section below. I find it pretty astonishing and bewildering

↳ 310 sats \ 13 replies \ [@petertodd](#) OP 20 Apr

As the pinned tweet on my Twitter says, "The hardest part about being a contrarian is knowing when not to be."

Lots of people just aren't that smart and go down ridiculous anti-mainstream, contrarian, rabbit holes when confronted with a clear case of good-vs-evil. They can't accept that there isn't any nuance to be had: Russia is simply evil and Ukraine isn't.

The other factor is Russian propaganda efforts. Some of this stuff is literally people being paid by Russia to make Ukraine look bad, as well as to weaken western civilization in general. China does this too.



The case for freezing quantum vulnerable coins

13.5k sats \ 31 comments \
[@benthecorman](#) 22 Apr bitcoin



During the last austin bitdevs we discussed the different trade offs between freezing and not freezing the quantum vulnerable coins. I brought up an argument that it seemed most people had not heard before so I wanted to write it out.

I first want to preface by saying I think quantum is mostly a LARP. From my view, we are very far away from being able to build a computer with enough qubits to do anything useful, we can't even get our current ones to run shor's algo without a million hacks. However I do think it'll happen one day, when we've built a dyson sphere and have cities on Mars, we probably will have figured it out by then. That day could be faster than I expect (certainly was for AI) but it seems this is more of a physical and engineering problem rather than a math / theory problem, which are much harder to solve.

--

The traditional freeze vs don't freeze argument is typically a philosophical debate about property rights. Should we freeze people's vulnerable coins to protect the rest of the network. Typically the argument is that since ~20% of all coins have exposed pubkeys, even if everyone using bitcoin today moved to quantum safe addresses, their coins could become worthless because quantum computers would steal all the vulnerable coins and crater the price of bitcoin, so everyone essentially loses their money, not just the people who didn't move over. The typical argument against this is sums up to: "not my problem, worst case is cheap bitcoin and a one time redistribution event", a more code is law stance. I mostly agree with this and definitely agree with this before we've actually seen proof of a QC breaking a 256 bit key. Regardless of how you feel about the potential property right violations here, I am going to make a security/game theory based argument on why bitcoin will need to freeze the coins once a quantum computer has been proven to able to crack coins.

Quantum vulnerable coins break mining incentives. Let me lay out the scenario. Assume that multiple labs have gotten to the point where they can break bitcoin keys and are now going all out, stealing as many coins as possible (the doomsday scenario). This will result in the same thing we normally see with low entropy keys where multiple people keep fee bumping until its eventually mostly miner fees and a small portion goes to miners. It will be slightly different as this will be millions of coins and multiple blocks worth of transactions rather than a one or two transactions. This is normal however, not what the real issue is. The real issue is that these labs will likely partner with big miners to prevent this race so they can steal the coins without the threat of fee bumping races. This could likely result the chain to temporarily split and forever leave a huge incentive for deep reorgs.

If we have large miners each pair with a quantum lab, they have no incentive to mine on top each other's blocks because there is a literal multi-million bitcoin incentive not to. This would likely result in a chain split between the two and then becomes a war of attrition, who can keep their miners on for longer until one runs out of money. During that period we would have a huge chain split and would have a hard time resolving it. We have no way to UASF out of this without just picking a winner or declaring them both losers and freezing the coins before they started the attack, both terrible options. This is the case for if multiple miners do it at the same time and tbh we'd have to pretty crazy luck for that to happen. What I think is more worrisome is the bounty these coins leave behind.



Currently there is not a huge incentive to 51% attack bitcoin. If you are able to 51% attack bitcoin and rewrite parts of the chain you can get block rewards that wouldn't have gone to you but it is a lot of risk when you could get similar rewards for just mining on the latest chain so the only real incentive is preventing new txs / censorship which has no real financial gain so we don't assume people will do this. However, quantum changes this equation. When there is a period of blocks that steal all the quantum vulnerable coins there is a HUGE incentive to reorg these blocks and instead steal them for yourself, even if they are buried under months to years worth of blocks. Today is there less than a million bitcoin left to be given out in the block subsidy, so the block reward will never be able to compete with the incentive there is to try to rewrite these old blocks and get the millions of bitcoin for yourself. This will forever be the case essentially until the block reward of all the blocks after equals the amount stolen (fees will need to go MUCH higher).

There are 2 real threats here, during the attack we lose all finality guarantees as miners will be reorging each other attempting to get the vulnerable coins for themselves, and after the attack there will always be an incentive to try again and get those coins.

Curious on people's thoughts on these potential attacks. I have not seen people even bring up any miner arguments for quantum vulnerable coins and haven't figured out my exact stance on what we should actually do. This is my best steel (steal?) man argument on why we should freeze the coins.

MEME MONDAY - Top Meme

555 sats \ 6 comments
\ @sn 20 Apr memes

186 sats \ 1 reply \ @hasherstacker 20 Apr

**Bro, if you just hustle more, you
can be bound by these gold
chains instead.**

